ZIP 11937, East Hampton and Springs

An El Niño winter here means more nor'easters. The danger is being cut off, not drowned: outages that stop furnaces, well pumps, and medical devices, generators run indoors, and Springs roads closed by the tide. The first move is to rebuild the Town's 2021 emergency registry by 1 December.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Suffolk County, NY (inferred)	None published for the US or New York	n/a here; global 6-month figure 239,000 ± 11,000	Nor'easter outages: no heat, no well water, generator CO; Springs roads cut off

13/13 recommendations checked. 0 confirmed outright, 8 corrected, 0 unverified, 5 contraindicated (the five *Do not* cards). The funding target fell 20% in verification, from $102,500 to $81,500, which is under the one-third threshold. Exposure: Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk*, September 2026, pre-peer-review. It publishes no figure for the United States or New York, and heat is not this place's winter hazard. No population-scaled figure is given here. The 5 resident steps (added 26 October 2026) were checked separately: 1 confirmed, 4 corrected.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



41.02°N 72.17°W, United States of America · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** Nor'easters cut power and roads. After Sandy, 2,100 Springs customers were still dark three days on, and Gerard Drive was impassable Monday to Wednesday.
- **For you.** By 1 December, get on the Town's emergency registry (631-329-6939), free. If anyone uses oxygen, enroll with PSEG too.*
- **The money.** $28,000 floor, $81,500 target, $158,500 ceiling. The cheapest lives saved are fuel deliveries for households HEAP misses.
- **Do not.** Do not hand out generators without a CO alarm and an outdoor-only rule. After Isaias, a generator in a Mastic basement sent four people to the hospital.*

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

READ THIS FIRST — EL NIÑO AND THIS ZIP

El Niño raises the odds of a stormy winter here. It does not cause the damage. The Northeast Regional Climate Center at Cornell finds that El Niño winters bring about two more coastal storms a winter to the region, and that 7 of 9 "crippling" Northeast snowstorms fell in El Niño winters. But this ZIP's own record shows cut-offs and outages in every ENSO phase. The only El Niño event in it is February 2016. Every action below is triggered by a storm, outage, or cold forecast, not by the El Niño label.

The request named a single street in Springs, East Hampton (Census geocoder). One street is too fine for this method, so the briefing covers ZIP 11937. It holds all of Springs, nearly all of East Hampton North and Northwest Harbor, 97% of East Hampton Village, and about 35% of Wainscott and 25% of Amagansett by land area (Census 2020 ZCTA-to-place file). Montauk (11954) and most of Napeague are outside it. It has 21,882 people, and 5,045 of them (23.1%) are 65 or over (ACS 2020–24). Three governments act here: the Town of East Hampton, the Village of East Hampton, and Suffolk County.

FOR YOU, AS A RESIDENT — 5 STEPS

For a resident of this ZIP, an El Niño winter means a nor'easter that takes the power for days, and with it the furnace, the well pump, and any medical device, and on the Springs bay shore, a flooded road out. No role was given with the request, so this section is written for a resident. The ranked actions below are written for the Town, the Village, and their partners. These are the ones you can take yourself.

1 · Get on the Town's emergency registry, and if anyone at home uses oxygen or other powered equipment, enroll with PSEG Long Island too

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 1

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
1 Dec 2026	None	Older people, people living alone, and device users

Call Town Human Services (631-329-6939) for its Emergency Evacuation Registry or its phone-only Reassurance Calling List, and tell them your heat source and whether you are on a well. PSEG's life-support (critical care) list needs a physician's certificate and brings daily contact in storms, but PSEG "cannot guarantee priority" in restoration, so you still need your own backup power: in New York City's 2003 blackout, hospitalizations for device failure rose about twelvefold.*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

2 · Check you have a working CO alarm with a battery, and run any generator outdoors only, at least 20 ft from doors and windows

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 3

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Before the first storm	About $25 per alarm (range $10–50; estimate)	Everyone asleep in the house

Amanda's Law already requires a CO alarm in any home with a fuel-burning appliance or an attached garage, rentals included; if your landlord has not fitted one, ask. Never run a generator in a garage, basement, or porch, and never heat with a gas oven: after Isaias, a generator in a Mastic basement sent four people to the hospital.*

3 · Apply for HEAP from 2 November, and do not let the oil or propane tank run low before January

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 4

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Apply from 2 Nov 2026	None to apply; worth up to $990, paid to your fuel vendor	A heated home through a cold snap

Regular HEAP pays up to $990 for oil, kerosene, or propane, and a household of four qualifies on up to $82,230 a year; it also unlocks PSEG Long Island's Household Assistance Program, worth $45–78 a month. Emergency HEAP opens only on 4 January 2027, and United Way's Project Warmth (call 211) only after that, so order fuel early rather than wait for a run-out in December.

4 · If you are on a private well, store water before each storm: at least 1 gallon per person per day for 3 days

CONFIRMED | RESIDENT STEP

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Before 1 Dec 2026, and topped up before each storm	Little or none, if you fill your own clean containers	Drinking water when the pump stops

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

A well pump runs on the grid, so an outage also means no water, and hundreds of East Hampton homes are still on private wells (Suffolk County Water Authority, 2024). CDC advises at least 1 gallon per person per day for 3 days, and a 2-week supply if possible; after a flood, do not drink the well water until it is tested.*

5 · On Gerard Drive, Louse Point, or the Clearwater lowlands, leave or stock up for three days when a coastal flood warning is issued

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 5

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Every coastal flood warning, all winter	Food and medicine for three days	Households cut off by water

In February 2016 Gerard Drive flooded and was closed for a day, and after Sandy it was impassable from Monday to Wednesday with its houses cut off. The road has since been raised about 2 ft, but how it performs in a big storm is unconfirmed, so decide before the tide whether you are going or staying.

After a long outage, claim for spoiled food. When 20,000 or more PSEG Long Island customers are out at once and some are out 72 hours or more, the account holder can claim up to $235 for food with an itemized list, or up to $540 with proof such as photos, plus prescription medicine at cost, within 14 days of the event ending. SNAP households can have food lost in an outage replaced: report it within 10 days, then file form LDSS-2291.

What to ask of the people in charge

- Ask the **Town Supervisor** what will open an overnight warming site this winter, and whether it will offer transport, Spanish, pets, and no ID required (action 2).
- Ask **Town Emergency Management** whether your street is on the Springs cut-off list, and who will check on you when Gerard Drive floods (action 5).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet. Every action was corrected in verification; the corrections are shown on each card.

1. Rebuild the Town's emergency registry by 1 December: call every name, record heat, water, and power-dependent devices, and enroll device users with PSEG

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · PUBLIC HEALTH · HISTORIAN · FRONTLINE · ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Town Human Services (128 Springs Fireplace Rd, 631-329-6939), with PSEG Long Island	1 Dec 2026	Staff time	Deaths from failed oxygen and other devices, and from cold homes with no water, in multi-day outages

The Town still circulates its "Emergency Evacuation Registry 2021" form and a Reassurance Calling List. Call every name on both, and every senior-meals client. Record the heat source, private well or public water, oxygen or other power dependence, and whether the person lives alone. Enroll device users in PSEG Long Island's life-support (critical care) list, which needs a physician's certificate. Hundreds of East Hampton homes still draw from private wells (Suffolk County Water Authority, 2024), so an outage there also means no water. In New York City's 2003 blackout, hospitalizations for medical-device failure rose about twelvefold (RR 12.15, 95% CI 6.84–21.58). Localized cold-season outages raised all-cause deaths by 6% (RR 1.06, 1.01–1.12) (Dominianni et al., *EHP* 2018).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: PSEG's leaflet says it "cannot guarantee priority" in restoration, and customers must arrange their own backup. Per the state's 2023 review of PSEG's emergency plan, it does put an outage with a life-support customer ahead of one without, makes daily contact during storms, and sends wellness visits with referral to the Suffolk County emergency operations center. The share of 11937 homes on wells is unknown. Transferability is moderate: the study covers dense, urban New York City on a networked grid. This ZIP is rural, on overhead lines, with longer outages and wells, so the local effect is plausibly larger, but that is not measured.

2. Write an overnight warming-shelter trigger by 15 December, with transport, Spanish, pets, and "no ID required" stated

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC · PHILANTHROPIST · FRONTLINE · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Town Supervisor, with the Village of East Hampton	15 Dec 2026	About $12,000 (our estimate; excludes generator fuel)	Older and isolated residents spending a night without heat in a cold outage

In the February 2026 cold snap (wind chill −25 °F), two Village sites stayed open overnight, from 6 pm Friday to 6 pm Monday: the Village Emergency Services Building and the East Hampton Fire Department meeting room. Town sites kept normal hours, and overnight cases were referred to Suffolk County DSS. The Town and Village should agree a written trigger, for example more than 2,000 customers out for over 12 hours, or wind chill at or below −10 °F. Use the Senior Center only if its backup power is confirmed; otherwise co-locate with the Village's 24-hour building. The cost is our arithmetic: 6 nights × 2 staff × 12 hours × $50 = $7,200, plus $3,000 for taxis and $1,800 for cots.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: there were two overnight Village sites in 2026, not one. The trigger values are an example, not a standard. No source confirms a Senior Center generator. No study gives an effect size for overnight warming shelters; the case rests on the cold-outage risk in action 1 (RR 1.06), so it is plausible, not proven.

3. Install 10-year CO alarms in crowded rentals and senior homes, and hand them out at pantry pickups, by Thanksgiving

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
East Hampton Fire Marshal and the Springs and East Hampton fire departments, with OLA and the pantries	26 Nov 2026 (Thanksgiving)	About $10,000 (400 alarms × ~$25, range $10–50; estimate)	Carbon monoxide deaths from generators and gas ovens run indoors in outages

Each alarm goes out with an English and Spanish card: run a generator outdoors only, never in a garage, basement, or porch, at least 20 ft from doors and windows, and never heat with a gas oven. Amanda's Law (in force since 22 February 2010) already requires CO alarms in homes with a fuel-burning appliance or an attached garage, rentals included. The gap is landlord compliance and homes the law does not cover. No free CO-alarm program was found locally; the Red Cross Sound the Alarm campaign installs smoke alarms. In Sandy, poison centers logged 263 CO exposures in 8 states, 80 of them in New York (CDC *MMWR*, 2012). CDC later found that most exposures came from improper generator use, despite messaging (Schnall et al., 2017).*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The evidence that alarms prevent harm is weak. One small Pittsburgh case series found symptoms in 13.3% of people with an alarm, against 63.4% without (Krenzelok et al., 1996; 101 exposures, unadjusted). The fire marshal should confirm that no CO giveaway already runs.

4. Close the heating-fuel gap: HEAP enrollment clinics from 2 November, and a small fuel bridge through OLA for households HEAP misses

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PHILANTHROPIST · ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Town Human Services, with OLA of Eastern Long Island; United Way of Long Island consulted	Clinics from 2 Nov 2026; bridge until 4 Jan 2027	$18,000 (24 deliveries × ~$750; estimate)	Households running out of oil or propane in a cold snap

Regular HEAP opens on 2 November 2026. It pays up to $990 for oil, kerosene, or propane, direct to the vendor, and the income limit for a household of four is $82,230 (Governor's release, 16 October 2026). Emergency HEAP opens on 4 January 2027. United Way's Project Warmth (call 211) pays vendors once Emergency HEAP is used up or denied, from about January. So the real gap is narrow: households waiting on HEAP processing, those who have used their roughly 200 gallons, and ineligible or mixed-status households. Run enrollment clinics now. Pay a small bridge through OLA, since the Town has no fuel fund, and require a filed HEAP application where the household is eligible. HEAP also unlocks PSEG Long Island's Household Assistance Program, worth $45–78 a month.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the gap is narrower than "no help until January", and Project Warmth is a partner to coordinate with, not duplicate. Heating oil was about $4.96 a gallon on Long Island in July 2026 (a secondary summary of NYSERDA; the NYSERDA page was blocked), so $750 a delivery is an estimate. No 2026 Household Assistance figure is published. No study measures deaths averted by a fuel bridge; the case is the cold-outage risk.

5. Use the Montauk tide gauge as the Springs cut-off trigger: watch at a forecast 4.7 ft, full plan at 4.9 ft

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | HISTORIAN · EMERGENCY MGR | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Town Emergency Management, with the Highway Department and Springs Fire Department	**Resident list by 1 Dec 2026; then on each forecast**	**Minimal (staff time)**	**Residents of the Gerard Drive peninsula, Louse Point, and the Clearwater lowlands cut off without help**

No real-time gauge exists in Gardiners Bay or Three Mile Harbor. The Montauk gauge (NOS 8510560) is the one the National Weather Service forecasts against. On 8 February 2016, at 4.7 ft MLLW, Napeague Meadow Road flooded and the *East Hampton Star* reported Gerard Drive flooded. On 24 February 1997, at 4.9 ft, Gerard Drive, Soak Hides Road, and Napeague Meadow Road flooded. In Sandy, at 7.1 ft, Gerard Drive was impassable from Monday to Wednesday and its houses were cut off. On a watch, the Highway Department and Springs Fire Department list the residents of the peninsula, Louse Point, and the Clearwater lowlands from action 1's registry. At 4.9 ft they pre-stage high-water access and supplies.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: Gerard Drive was raised 2 ft, to 6 ft, with $865,000 of FEMA money (work from September 2018, target June 2019). Completion and performance are unconfirmed; at 5.1 ft on 17 December 2020, no Gerard Drive impact was recorded. Every threshold here predates the raising, so re-check it after the next event. Bay-side surge in Springs can differ from Montauk.

6. Reach the families avoiding official sites: Spanish alerts over WhatsApp, food delivery, and a new cash line through OLA

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · FOOD · ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
OLA of Eastern Long Island (631-899-3441), with the Springs and East Hampton food pantries	From November 2026 through March 2027	$25,000 ($400 × 50 households + $5,000 outreach; estimate)	Families going without food, heat, and warnings because they fear official sites

OLA, founded in 2002, and the pantries rebroadcast PSEG and Town alerts in Spanish over WhatsApp, deliver food to families who stopped coming, and run an unconditional cash line. The Springs Food Pantry serves nearly 400 families, more than 1,500 people, a week, and saw record demand last winter. The East Hampton Food Pantry had served 4,244 families by late April 2024, topped 1,000 people in one week in February 2025, and already delivers to senior housing. Nearby, at the Long Island Cares pantry in Hampton Bays, visits fell 21% in one week after ICE detained 12 people (News12, 13 November 2025).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: Hampton Bays is in the Town of Southampton, outside 11937, and the 21% covers one week, so it is context, not a local trend. OLA received $80,000 in New York Community Trust grants in 2025, but no record shows it paying cash at this scale. This is a new line for OLA, so ask for its vetting and payout time before committing. No delivery route aimed at these families runs today.

7. Stock the pantries for storm weeks by 15 December, and give Meals on Wheels clients 3-day shelf-stable packs

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
East Hampton Food Pantry, with the Springs Food Pantry and East Hampton Meals on Wheels	15 Dec 2026	$15,000 stock + $1,500 packs (estimates)	Pantries closing empty, and homebound seniors going hungry, after a nor'easter

Pre-buy shelf-stable, no-cook stock, sized to the storage each pantry can confirm; the East Hampton pantry was "almost out of space" in February 2025. Hold the rest on account at Long Island Cares. East Hampton Meals on Wheels is an independent nonprofit (631-329-1669) with about 45 clients; give each a 3-day storm pack. Tell SNAP households to report food lost in an outage within 10 days, then file form LDSS-2291 (7 CFR 274.6). New SNAP work rules took effect in New York on 1 March 2026: adults 18–64 without a child under 14 must log 80 hours a month, and volunteering counts if Suffolk DSS approves it.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: Meals on Wheels has about 45 clients, not 150 (*East Hampton Star*, undated; confirm by phone). Storage, not money, is the limit, so the $15,000 is released to each pantry only once its space is confirmed. No standing storm-stock program runs at the pantries, so this does not duplicate Island Harvest or Long Island Cares.

8. Plug the Town into PSEG Long Island's existing municipal system by 1 December, with a backup channel that does not depend on Verizon

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Town Supervisor, with PSEG Long Island and Town Emergency Management	1 Dec 2026	None	The Senior Center, shelter, and water pumps waiting in the restoration queue

PSEG Long Island already runs municipal liaisons, a municipal hotline, and a Municipal Portal, and restores critical facilities first. The Town confirms its named contacts there. It checks that the Senior Center, any shelter, and the Suffolk County Water Authority pump stations serving 11937 are on the critical-facility list. It also tests a backup channel, such as radio through the Suffolk County emergency operations center. In Isaias (August 2020), PSEG's text line, phone line, website, and outage map all failed, and PSEG blamed its dependence on Verizon. State regulators found more than 70 potential violations of its emergency plan, and LIPA filed a $70 million claim.

Correction: the liaison system largely exists, so the action is to use and test it, not to create it. Whether East Hampton's own facilities are on PSEG's list is not public.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	Town Human Services	Town Supervisor	Town Emergency Mgmt	Highway Dept	Village of East Hampton	Fire depts & Fire Marshal	PSEG LI	OLA	Food pantries	Meals on Wheels	United Way LI
1. Rebuild the emergency registry	**A/R**		**C**				**R**			**C**	
2. Overnight shelter trigger	**C**	**A**	**C**		**R**						
3. CO alarms and generator cards						**A/R**		**R**	**R**		
4. HEAP clinics and fuel bridge	**A/R**							**R**			**C**
5. Springs cut-off plan	**C**		**A**	**R**		**R**					
6. Reach families avoiding official sites								**A/R**	**R**		
7. Storm food stock and packs									**A/R**	**R**	
8. PSEG municipal links and backup channel		**A**	**R**				**R**				

What the chart shows: **Town Human Services is accountable for the two rows that reach people at home** (the registry and the fuel gap), so it carries most of the life-saving work. **The Town Supervisor is accountable for two rows that need a decision, not money**: the overnight trigger and the PSEG arrangements. **OLA and the pantries appear on four rows**, because they are the only doors many Latino families will open. Rows 2, 5, and 8 need a written decision; rows 4, 6, and 7 need money.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs. No published cost per death averted exists for US winter outage or heating help, so amounts are cost per household reached, labeled as estimates.

FLOOR	TARGET	CEILING	LARGEST UNCERTAINTY
$28,000	$81,500	$158,500	How many oil and propane households in 11937 fall through HEAP; no count exists

Floor: fuel bridge, 24 deliveries ≈ $18,000, plus OLA cash for 25 households, $10,000 = $28,000. Below this, the November–December gap stays open. **Target:** $18,000 fuel + $25,000 OLA cash and outreach + $12,000 overnight shelter + $15,000 pantry stock + $1,500 Meals on Wheels packs + $10,000 CO alarms = $81,500. **Ceiling:** $72,000 fuel + $40,000 OLA + $20,000 pantries + $12,000 shelter + $4,500 packs + $10,000 alarms = $158,500. Beyond that, these organizations cannot vet and pay out before the peak. **The target fell 20% in verification**, from

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

$102,500: the fuel bridge was halved from $36,000 because HEAP pays from November, and the Meals on Wheels packs fell from $4,500 because it has about 45 clients, not 150.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
OLA of Eastern Long Island, with Town Human Services referrals	Action 4: fuel bridge for households HEAP misses	$18,000 (was $36,000); ceiling $72,000 pending a household count	Pooled fund paying fuel vendors	24 deliveries × ~$750 (estimate); requires a filed HEAP application where eligible	Partially confirmed
OLA of Eastern Long Island	Action 6: unconditional cash and Spanish outreach	$25,000 (floor $10,000; ceiling $40,000)	Cash transfer	$400 × 50 households + $5,000 outreach; a new disbursement line for OLA	Partially confirmed
Town of East Hampton, with the Village	Action 2: overnight warming shelter	$12,000, only once a written trigger is adopted (floor $0)	Matching grant	6 nights × 2 staff × 12 h × $50 + $3,000 taxis + $1,800 cots (our arithmetic)	Partially confirmed
East Hampton and Springs food pantries	Action 7: storm-week stock	$15,000 (ceiling $20,000)	Pre-positioned stock	Judgment call; released to each pantry once storage is confirmed, the rest held at Long Island Cares	Partially confirmed
East Hampton Meals on Wheels	Action 7: 3-day storm packs	$1,500 (was $4,500)	Pre-positioned stock	About 45–50 clients × $30 (estimate)	Partially confirmed
Springs and East Hampton fire departments	Action 3: CO alarms and bilingual cards	$10,000	Direct grant	~400 alarms × ~$25 (estimate); a stopgap for illegal and crowded rentals under Amanda's Law	Partially confirmed

Already funded, so not duplicated: Regular and Emergency HEAP, Project Warmth, the Suffolk County DSS overnight shelter, Maureen's Haven, the Village's overnight building, and Red Cross smoke alarms. No anticipatory-action framework covers the US. PSEG's own outage payment is the only money here that moves on a trigger: up to $235 for food with an itemized list, or $540 with proof, plus medication at actual loss, when

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

20,000 or more customers are out for 72 hours or more. Claims are due within 14 days. Whether tenants who are not account holders can claim is unclear; we infer they cannot.

The funder's one thing: donors here give to food. The November–December fuel gap, and the families afraid of official sites, are what no one pays for.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives or waste the window here.

Hand out or promote portable generators without a CO alarm and a written outdoor-only rule *

CONTRAINDICATED

After Isaias, on 7 August 2020, a generator running in a Mastic basement forced six people out of the house and sent four to the hospital (ABC7). After Sandy, on 5 November 2012, a 44-year-old woman in Oceanside died from a generator in her attached garage (Patch). CDC found that most Sandy CO exposures came from improper generator use, despite messaging.

Instead: pair every generator with a CO alarm and a written English and Spanish rule: outdoors only, never in a garage, basement, or porch, and at least 20 ft from doors and windows (action 3).

Announce daytime library "warming sites" as the cold plan

CONTRAINDICATED

The risk peaks overnight. In February 2026 the libraries and the Senior Center kept normal hours. Only Village sites stayed open overnight, and the Town sent overnight cases to Suffolk County DSS.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: keep daytime sites as an addition, and name one overnight site, with transport, pets, and a "no ID required" statement in Spanish, before the first nor'easter (action 2).

Rely on PSEG's app and text outage system, or Town phone lines, to warn people and check on them

CONTRAINDICATED

In Isaias, PSEG's text line, phone line, website, and outage map all failed. On 20 February 2025, some Town phone lines went down, though Police lines held.

Instead: plan on in-person checks by the fire departments and buddies, the Police line, and WLNG radio (actions 1 and 8).

Plan on emergency sandbags, bulkheads, or geobags to defend ocean and bay frontage after the first storm

CONTRAINDICATED

Town Code Chapter 255 (Coastal Erosion Overlay) allows new erosion-control structures in only one of four zones, by special permit. Emergency sandbags or geotextile are allowed only for about 6–9 months, to save a structure in imminent danger, and they tend to stay. Geocubes on Bay View Avenue in Amagansett have stood for more than 10 years, and the Montauk geobags are reburied every year.

Instead: move vehicles and valuables out of the flood zone, and repair dunes with sand only.

Buy parametric heat or wage insurance for households or workers

CONTRAINDICATED

No such product is sold to households or workers in New York. The best-known scheme, SEWA's in India, paid about $2–20 per worker. The loss here is a lost season of work, not a lost day.

Instead: put the money into HEAP enrollment and OLA's cash line (actions 4 and 6).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
Sep 1938	Hurricane; 164 trees down on East Hampton's Main Street; Napeague breached and Montauk cut off for 2 days, outside the ZIP (no ONI before 1950; not re-checked)	No East Hampton death count found	—
Feb 1997	Nor'easter; Gerard Drive, Soak Hides Road, and Napeague Meadow Road flood at 4.9 ft MLLW at Montauk (neutral)	None found	NWS ties these roads to this level in its impact catalogue
Oct 2012	Sandy; 21,000+ Town customers out; 2,100 still out in Springs on 1 November; 90 in the East Hampton High School shelter; Gerard Drive impassable Monday to Wednesday (neutral)	No local deaths reported	Gerard Drive raised 2 ft with $865,000 of FEMA money, 2018–19; completion unconfirmed
Feb 2013	Blizzard, federal disaster DR-4111 (neutral)	None found	FEMA Public Assistance: Town $212,623, Village $89,954
Feb 2016	Nor'easter; Napeague Meadow Road floods at 4.7 ft; the *Star* reports Gerard Drive flooded (strong El Niño, the only El Niño event in this record)	None found	—
Aug 2020	Isaias; PSEG's text, phone, website, and outage map fail; about 8 days to restore island-wide; about 200 still out from Hampton Bays to Montauk by Wednesday (La Niña developing)	None found locally	State found 70+ potential violations; LIPA filed a $70 million claim
Feb 2025	21,500+ East End customers out after a car crash in Southold, restored within hours; some Town phone lines down (weak La Niña)	None found	—
Feb 2026	Cold snap, wind chill −25 °F; two Village sites open overnight; Town refers overnight cases to Suffolk County DSS (weak La Niña or neutral)	Not reported	No written Town overnight trigger yet (action 2)

The recurrence nobody has noticed: the danger in Springs is being cut off, not drowned. Gerard Drive floods at known water levels, and outages stop furnaces and well pumps. No storm death is on record in this ZIP. The deaths to expect are quiet ones: in a cold house, in a

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basement with a generator, or on a device that stopped.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **Organize the winter plan around the Napeague causeway** (historian: 1938, 1997, 2016) versus **the scope of this ZIP**. Napeague and Montauk lie outside 11937, so the in-ZIP chokepoint is Gerard Drive and Louse Point, and action 5 is built on that.
- **El Niño adds little local signal** (skeptic, emergency manager: the record shows events in every phase) versus **the regional storm-frequency link** (NRCC, Cornell). Both hold. Plan on the storm forecast, not the label.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

Nobody tracks winter deaths by cause here. The deaths will be recorded as CO poisoning, a cardiac arrest the morning after a storm, or an oxygen concentrator that stopped. Each appears as one case in a different register, so no one sees the pattern (public health lens). **No one has counted how many homes in 11937 rely on private wells and oil heat.** That count would size actions 1 and 4, and the funding ceiling depends on it.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale, roughly 300,000 people. They are not neighborhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; nor'easters, outages, cold, coastal flooding, and carbon monoxide are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED — METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The request named a single street in Springs, East Hampton, NY 11937 (Census geocoder), and one street is too fine for this method, so the briefing was built at ZCTA 11937 (21,882 people, ACS 2020–24). Its places were checked against the Census 2020 ZCTA-to-place file.

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Climate Impact Lab impact region, as this report records it: Suffolk County, NY, inferred rather than resolved on the Impact Map. Mortality figures exist only at that scale (impact regions average roughly 300,000 people); sub-city detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.

- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Heat is not this place's winter hazard, so the historical record carries the hazard instead.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias before it counted in an action's favor: the historian's causeway plan centered on Napeague, which lies outside the ZIP, so it was re-aimed at Gerard Drive. Contradictions were kept. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, given payers or marked unfunded, and reconciled against the funding placements.
- **Verification.** Five separate verifier agents checked the 8 actions, the 5 contraindicated items, the scope, the historical record, and the funding placements, on evidence, transferability, and feasibility. Financial actions were also checked for availability in New York, a named payer, a trigger, and whether they already exist. The food actions and the funding envelope had their own verifier, and the envelope was re-summed. Verifiers read the Census ZCTA-to-place file and the Census geocoder, Census Reporter's ACS tables, OpenFEMA Public Assistance records, the NWS Montauk impact catalogue, and the 2026 Suffolk County hazard plan annex directly.
- **Reader.** No role was given, so the For you section is written for a resident. It was added on 26 October 2026, after this briefing was first sent; its steps come from the verified actions and were checked on the same three tests.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organization named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not consulted for this location. The inventory is a client-side app that renders no entries without a browser session. No action here is marked as having or lacking a precedent there.

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- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (emergency registries, oxygen, CO alarms, generators, and water in an outage) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. The impact region was not resolved on the Impact Map. Census QuickFacts and the Census API needed a key, so the 2020 decennial count was not checked. The Town's 2026 Human Services programs PDF and the Town website returned 403, so the registry form was read from its indexed PDF. NYSERDA returned 403, so the oil price is from a secondary summary. ENSO phases are from NOAA's ONI table as recalled by the verifier, not re-fetched (±0.1). Two events the lenses reported, Irene in 2011 and an early-1990s storm that "washed away two houses," could not be verified and are omitted.

References · Census 2020 ZCTA-to-place file (queried) · Census geocoder (queried) · Census Reporter, ZCTA 11937 (verified) · NRCC Cornell, El Niño and Northeast winters (lens) · Dominianni et al., EHP 2018 (verified) · Town Emergency Evacuation Registry 2021 (verified, indexed copy) · PSEG LI special-needs customers leaflet (verified) · DPS review of PSEG LI emergency plan, 2023 (verified) · PSEG LI emergency plan update, 2021 (verified) · SCWA, South Fork main extensions (verified) · EH Star, warming centers, Feb 2026 (verified) · EH Star, East End outage, Feb 2025 (corrected) · Riverhead Local, Isaias communications failure (verified) · LIPA, Isaias timeline and claim (verified) · EH Star, Isaias locally (verified) · Krenzelok et al. 1996 (verified) · CDC MMWR, Sandy CO exposures (verified) · Schnall et al. 2017 (verified) · NY DHSES, Amanda's Law (verified) · Red Cross smoke alarms, Suffolk (verified) · Red Cross Sound the Alarm 2026 (verified) · ABC7, Mastic generator CO, 2020 (verified) · Patch, Oceanside generator death, 2012 (verified) · Governor's release, HEAP 2026–27 (verified) · OTDA 25DC093, HEAP vendor payments (verified) · Project Warmth (verified) · PSEG LI Household Assistance Program, 2025 (corrected to $45–78) · PSEG LI outage compensation (corrected) · New York Community Trust grants, 2025 (verified) · EH Star, OLA deliveries, 2020 (corrected; no cash record) · Suffolk HMP 2026, Town of East Hampton annex (verified) · NWS OKX, Montauk Point impacts (verified) · EH Star, "Snow, Tide = Floods," 2016 (corrected) · 27east, Gerard Drive raising, 2019 (verified) · 27east, coastal resiliency plan, 2022 (verified) · Coastal Erosion Overlay District, Ch. 255 (verified) · Surfrider, East Hampton coastal law (verified) · EH Star, sandbag removal, 2023 (verified) · EH Star, sandbags blocking beach, 2019 (verified) · Patch, Sandy in East Hampton (corrected: three days, not two) · OpenFEMA Public Assistance, DR-4111 (queried; corrected) · News12, Hampton Bays pantry, Nov 2025 (corrected: outside the ZIP) · James Lane Post, Springs Food Pantry, 2026 (verified) · EH Star, East Hampton Food Pantry, 2024 (verified) · EH Star letters, Feb 2025 (verified) · EH Star, Meals on Wheels (verified, undated) · Dan's Papers, Meals on Wheels, 2020 (verified) · LI Herald, Island Harvest shelter supply (verified) · OTDA 08DC031, SNAP food-loss replacement (verified) · OTDA 24DC050, SNAP waiver (verified) · News12, SNAP work rules, 2026 (verified) · Montauk Library, 1938 hurricane (lens; not re-checked) · EH Star, lessons of 1938 (lens; not re-checked) · NOAA ONI table (recalled, not re-fetched) · For you · CDC, emergency water supply [confirmed] · PSEG Long Island, outage compensation [confirmed]

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Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

Generated 26 October 2026 for ZIP 11937, East Hampton and Springs. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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